Robert Hooke



Born on the Isle of Wight, England, Hooke showed an early interest in science. A small inheritance allowed him to attend the prestigious Westminster School, where he excelled, earning a place at Oxford University. There he assisted the natural philosophers John Wilkins and Robert Boyle. In 1662 Hooke became the first curator of experiments for the Royal Society of London. In 1665 he became Professor of Physics at Gresham College.

Like many scientists of his day, Hooke had a broad range of interests. His achievements include some early insights into the wave theory of light; the construction of some of the earliest telescopes; and the formulation of Hooke's Law. Hooke was also a respected architect, an activity that made him a wealthy man.

Key works

1665 *Micrographia*

1674 *An Attempt to Prove the Motion of the Earth*

1676 *A Description of Helioscopes and Some Other Instruments*

See also: Classification of living things • A system for identifying all nature's organisms • Microbiology • Thermoregulation in insects